



EDUARDO VERDUGO Associated Press

HURRICANE POLO SLAMS MEXICO

A resident wades home in Puerto San Carlos after the storm made landfall twice on Tuesday. **WORLD, A3**

New laws take on federal migrant policies

Newsom signs bills that include banning use of shock gloves and other ICE tactics.

By NICOLE NIXON

SACRAMENTO — Gov. Gavin Newsom signed a raft of bills designed to push back on the Trump administration's immigration enforcement in California, including a ban on electric shock gloves and a revamped ban on law enforcement face coverings after a previous law was blocked by a federal judge.

The more than 20 bills approved by the governor Tuesday were crafted to thwart tactics used by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents, including the use of facial coverings and making arrests outside courthouse immigration hearings. Other bills are meant to boost state oversight of federal detention centers.

"Trump has put his political interests above the health, safety and livelihood of American families. California is taking action to strengthen transparency, accountability, and oversight around immigration enforcement in our state," Newsom said in a statement. "This is about stepping up where the federal government has failed our communities. We will continue protecting our people, upholding the rule of law, and making clear that if the federal government operates in California, we will hold them accountable." [See ICE, A7]

LAPD is more diverse, but bias is still an issue

Racism persists after years of effort, case shows

By Libor Jany

A Black police officer asked whether a monkey was named "Tyrone," to the laughter of a roomful of Latino and Asian colleagues.

A Latina cop described how to inflict maximum pain: "You hit Black people in the liver — I heard they got weak livers," she said, according to an LAPD internal affairs report.

The report said their boss, an Asian sergeant, stood by as his employees used terms like "midnight" and "chocolate, chocolate" to describe people's skin tones.

Those were among the comments that came to light last year after an LAPD whistleblower secretly recorded his colleagues in a unit that screens police recruits.

The scandal, which has seen new developments in recent weeks, is forcing department officials to reckon with a harsh reality: Years of efforts to make the LAPD more diverse have seemingly done little to

stamp out prejudice in the ranks.

For much of its history, the Los Angeles Police Department was a white man's department. Aggressive tactics in communities of color fueled racial uprisings in the 1960s and early 1990s, when the beating of motorist Rodney King led to the discovery of messages similar to those in the recruitment unit tapes, with officers referring to Black men as "Buckwheat" and bragging about "busting heads."

Under pressure from lawsuits and consent decrees, police leaders pushed to recruit more Black, Latino and Asian officers, seeking to build up trust in minority communities.

Latino now make up more than half of the 8,500-officer department. Black officers constitute less than 9% of the force, coinciding with a decline in the city's Black population.

The officer who made the recruitment unit recordings, Daniel Flores, is Latino. He recorded [See LAPD, A7]

Trump ads face blowback

Even GOP lawmakers object to tapping taxpayer funds to promote the president.

By LISA MASCARO AND ALI SWENSON

WASHINGTON — The Department of Homeland Security has tapped \$20 million to pay for the campaign-style ads glorifying President Trump that have drawn widespread criticism from Republicans and Democrats as a blatant misuse of taxpayer dollars that probably runs afoul of anti-propaganda law.

The White House has fiercely defended the ads, calling them public service announcements.

"Don't let the Fake News get away with their lies about our epic Public Service Announcements that have been running on tv," White House communications director Steven Cheung posted Sunday on X.

But the Republican administration's ads have attracted mounting criticism, including from members of Trump's party.

"It shouldn't be paid for with taxpayer dollars," Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R-S.D.) told reporters.

"It would not have been something that I would have done," said Sen. Mike Rounds, another South Dakota Republican.

Multiple legal experts said the ads appear to run afoul of federal statutes, including a law against con-

gressionally appropriated funds being used for "publicity or propaganda" and a law that limits the partisan political activities of government employees.

They said the new ads, which are airing on network and cable TV and streaming, differ from other administrations' PSAs because they aren't designed to help Americans access any specific program.

Three ads have aired in less than a week.

The first ad in the campaign, which began airing Sept. 23, features clips of Trump talking about defeating communism interspersed with onscreen text promoting the "largest tax cuts in history," "Reigniting American manufacturing" and a call to "defend law and [See Ads, A8]

GOP voters in state souring on Trump, poll finds

Gas prices, war sap enthusiasm and could hurt turnout, party's candidates in midterms.

By BEN WIEDER

With gas prices topping \$6 a gallon and an unpopular war continuing in Iran, President Trump's approval has slipped with California Republicans — a falloff that could diminish the party's chances in the state's few competitive congressional races.

A new poll by the UC Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies, co-sponsored by The Times, found that 76% of Republican voters in the state approve of the president's performance, down from 83% last year.

The president's approval has softened even among those who still support his performance. Only 44% of Republicans in California said they strongly support Trump's performance, down from 57% who said the same in August 2025.

That could translate into lower Republican turnout in

the state's few competitive races, said the poll's director, Mark DiCamillo.

"Republicans are losing some of their enthusiasm in terms of being motivated to vote," he said.

In addition, the more Trump tries to make the midterm elections about himself — such as recent pro-Trump ads sponsored and paid for by the government — the more Democrats might be inclined to show up, said G. Cristina Mora, the UC Berkeley institute's co-director.

"That might actually have a galvanizing effect on voters," she said.

Trump's sinking support in California mirrors a national decline in the president's approval, even among Republicans.

The congressional map in the state was already challenging for Republicans after voters last year approved a referendum championed by Gov. Gavin Newsom to redraw districts to be more favorable for Democrats — a response to similar efforts by Republicans in Texas and other states.

In the new map, only four of the state's 52 districts are [See Republicans, A6]



FRANCIS CHUNG Politico

REP. David Valadao (R-Hanford) is in the state's only true toss-up race, the Cook Political Report says.

Bitter showdown over Pelosi's seat

The race between two Democrats to succeed the former speaker is dividing the party.

By KEVIN RECTOR

After being securely held for nearly four decades by one of the most preeminent politicians in California history, the House seat to represent bright-blue San Francisco in Congress is up for grabs in November — and dividing the Democratic Party.

Rep. Nancy Pelosi (D-San Francisco), 86, the powerful former House speaker who has held the seat since 1987, announced last year that she would not run again. In May, she passed over state Sen. Scott Wiener (D-San Francisco) — a prolific California legislator long considered a potential successor — to endorse San Francisco Supervisor Connie Chan, a local progressive with less legislative experience but strong support from labor.

Pelosi's endorsement sent Chan, who had been

languishing in polls, surging past Democratic tech millionaire Saikat Chakrabarti in the June primary. Chan finished with nearly 30% of the vote and Chakrabarti took 18%. Wiener won, with nearly 41% of the vote.

Both Wiener, a gay man and staunch advocate for the city's large LGBTQ+ community, and Chan, who immigrated to the city from Hong Kong at age 13 and has deep ties to its large Chinese and immigrant communities, would make history by winning. Wiener would be the first out LGBTQ+ person to represent the city in Congress, and Chan the first Asian American immigrant woman.

The race has sharply divided the state's Democratic establishment as a rare intraparty showdown between a deft legislator who has driven liberal California policy for years and a rising progressive with the powerful imprimatur of the icon they seek to replace.

Both acknowledge they would take the same or similar positions on many issues, and fiercely oppose President Trump's agenda. But [See San Francisco, A6]

Santa Monica art hub fears its demise

Bergamot Station was a neglected, decaying railroad station and industrial zone when Craig Krull first saw it back in 1994.

He and others envisioned it being something so much more. And within a few years, it was one of the world's most exciting artist hubs. At its zenith, the collection of buildings housed world-famous galleries and artist exhibitions that made the gritty section of Santa Monica an unlikely contemporary art capital.

"You squint your eyes, and you have a vision," Krull, owner of a founding gallery at the Bergamot, said in an interview. "It's been emulated around the world."

But now, Bergamot Station is facing an uncertain future.

Santa Monica is consid-

City plans to turn Bergamot Station into affordable housing

By Salvador Hernandez



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

PAINTER Gronk discusses his work with Santa Monica College students visiting Bergamot Station.

ering a plan to turn the 32-year-old center into new homes, part of its effort to meet state requirements in providing affordable housing in the beach city. During its Sept. 8 meeting, the City Council met behind closed doors with developers to turn the 5.6-acre property into more than 700 affordable homes.

The possibility of its being torn down has placed artists and gallery owners in limbo, as they await the fate of the art center.

In its heyday, more than 30 galleries filled their spaces with the work of established, renowned artists and young, upcoming artists, many of whom would go on to international acclaim.

Artists such as Retna, Man Ray, John Valadez, [See Bergamot, A8]

Six Flags' X2 coaster closed for good

After string of passenger injuries, Magic Mountain has shut down the ride permanently. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Dodgers look to win with wisdom

L.A., with oldest lineup in majors, has chance to become first NL team to three-peat. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather

Sunshine. L.A. Basin: 85/65. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**

New owner for 2 SoCal bookstores

A Pasadena native takes over Vroman's and Book Soup after a lengthy search. **BUSINESS, A9**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.



7 85944 00200 5